

Selling wine to the wrong room

How iFood's campaign budget found the customers least likely to say yes.

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Data iFood / Kaggle • 2,205 customers • 5 campaigns

Five campaigns went out. Most customers said no. The dataset records who accepted what, alongside demographics, household, income, spend by category, and channel. The obvious question is who responded. The question a marketing manager actually pays for is whether the next campaign should look like the last five.

This analysis argues it shouldn't — and shows exactly where the budget should move. Three findings, three queries, one conclusion: the campaign engine treats the customer base as uniform, and the base is anything but.

2× YOUNGEST SEGMENT CONVERTS AT TWICE THE LARGEST SEGMENT'S RATE	2.6× CATALOG USE IS 2.6× HIGHER IN HOUSEHOLDS WITHOUT CHILDREN	~60× WINE SPEND SCALES ~60× ACROSS THE INCOME RANGE
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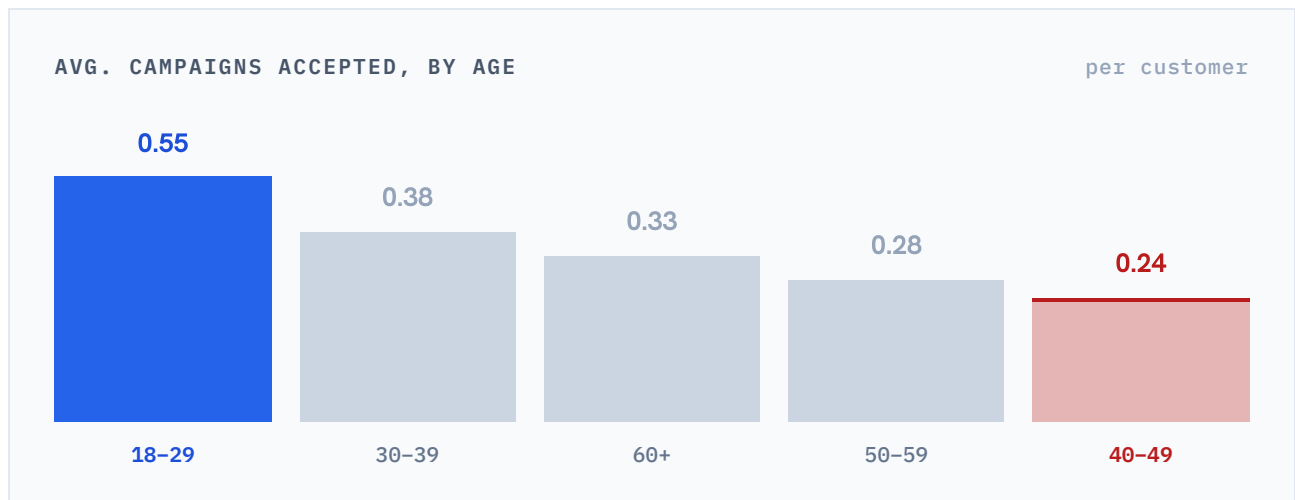
2,205 records, 29 variables. Cleaned in Excel — age and income binned, household flagged, total spend summed across six categories. 198 records tagged **2n Cycle** were recoded to Master under the Bologna framework. Analysis in SQL over a SQLite build; visualised in Tableau.

FINDING 01

The biggest segment is the coldest audience

The 40–49 bracket is the largest group in the base. It is also the least responsive: **16.4%** accepted at least one campaign. The 18–29 bracket — the smallest cohort — converted at **32.6%**. Double the rate.

Read as a targeting story, this is budget flowing to volume rather than propensity. Five campaigns hit the most populated segment and converted one customer in six. The same campaigns hit the youngest segment and converted one in three. Every pound shifted from the middle bracket to the youngest roughly doubles its expected return.

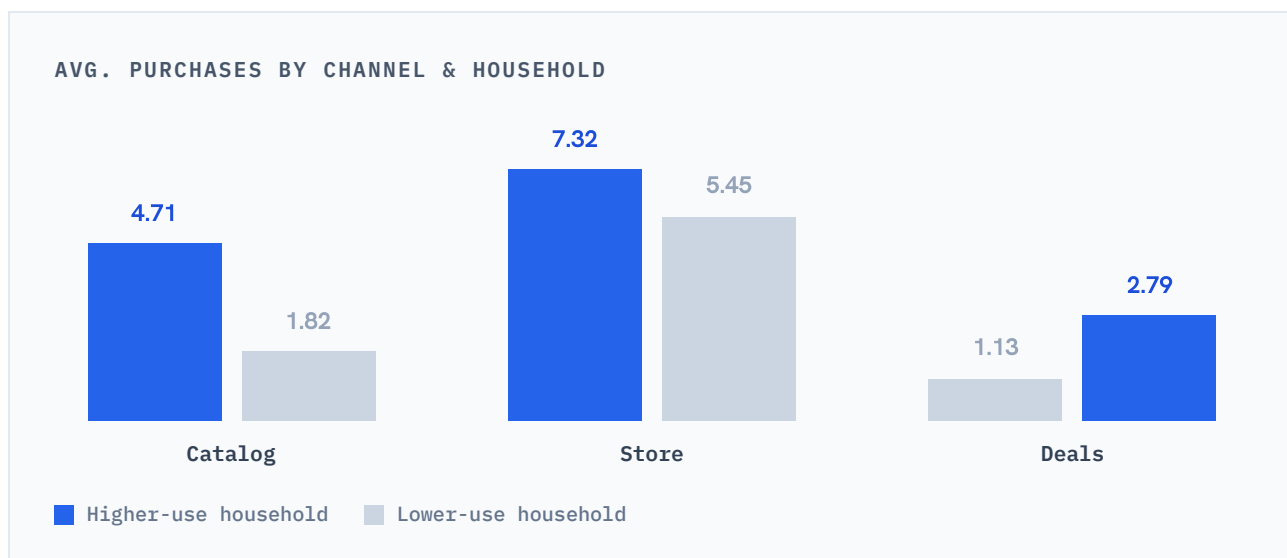


The 40–49 segment is too large to abandon, and its low response may say more about the offers than the audience. The move is to stop sending one message to everyone: scale what already works for the young, and hold the middle bracket's budget until different creative, offers, or channels are tested.

FINDING 02

Children change the channel

Households without children average **4.71** catalog purchases. Households with children average **1.82**. The gap repeats in store visits — and inverts for deals, where parents (2.79) outbuy childless customers (1.13).

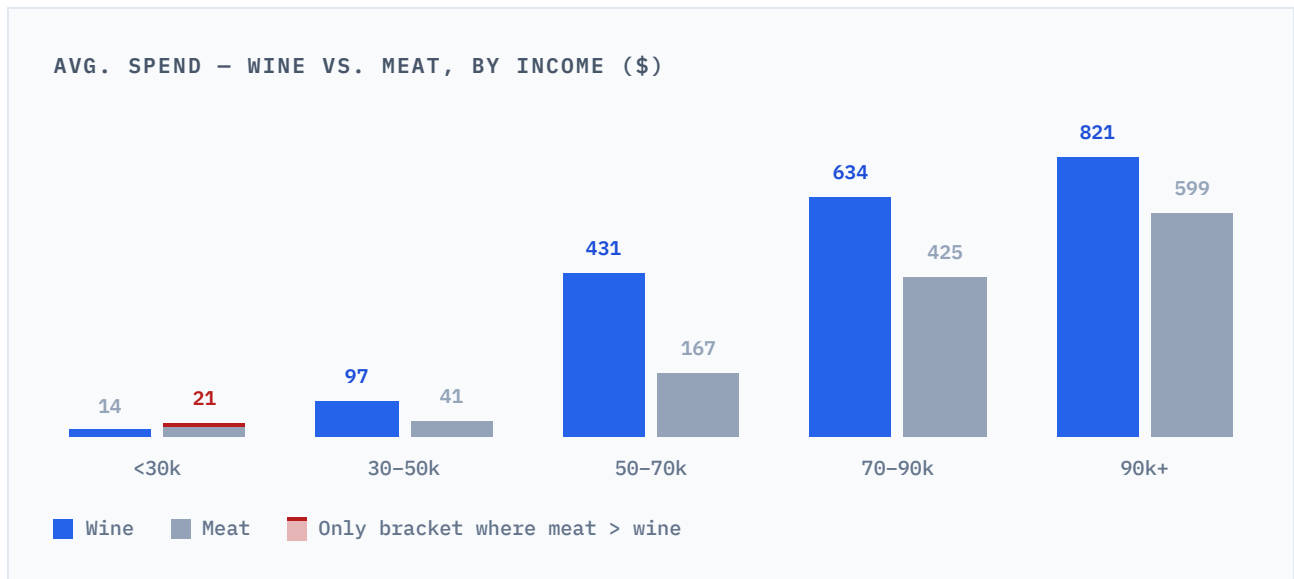


The read is simple. Catalog and store shopping are browsing behaviours — they take time, and time is what disappears when children arrive. What replaces browsing is price sensitivity: parents hunt discounts and skip the premium channels. A catalog mailed to a family household is mostly wasted print. Deal-led campaigns already have their audience raising a hand. The has-children flag is already in the CRM, so this segmentation is nearly free to ship.

FINDING 03

Wine is the income signal

Average spend scales steeply with income — from **\$72** in the lowest bracket to **\$1,740** in the highest. Expected. The useful detail is where the money goes. Wine dominates every bracket above \$30k and scales hardest, climbing from \$13.78 to \$820.49 — a factor of nearly sixty. Meat scales too, but at half the slope. Only below \$30k does the order flip: meat (\$21.46) outspends wine (\$13.78).



Two implications. First, wine spend works as an income proxy inside the transaction data itself — useful wherever declared income is missing or stale. Second, premium campaigns have a ceiling. The sub-\$30k bracket holds **370 customers (≈17% of the base)** whose basket says they shop for the table, not the cellar. Sending them premium wine offers spends money to generate irritation. A value-range offer is the only campaign type with a realistic chance there.

WHAT I'D TELL THE MARKETING MANAGER

Three findings, one problem: the engine treats the base as uniform. Three moves, in order of implementation cost.

- 01** Split audiences by age. Shift budget toward the 18-29 segment, where conversion runs at twice the middle bracket's rate.

- 02** Gate catalog on the has-children flag. Route family households toward deal-led offers instead.

- 03** Build a value-tier campaign for sub-\$30k — and exclude that segment from premium wine promotions entirely.

None of this needs new data collection. Every segmentation field already exists in the table. The cost of the current approach is invisible because it shows up as mediocre average acceptance rather than a line item — which is exactly why segment-level analysis is worth running before the next campaign ships.

Method — Deliberately descriptive: three business questions, three SQL queries, one dashboard. The snapshot carries no transaction dates or campaign cost, ruling out cohort, CLV, and return-on-spend analysis. Where the data supports a claim, it's made; where it doesn't, the limit is stated.

Sources — Dashboard: public.tableau.com/app/profile/david.kamande2809 · Repo: github.com/ngatho1/iFood-Campaign-Analysis